



November 2023

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OTCR's two-fold mission is to create meaningful value for clients and invaluable experiences for students.

Client Service



First, our mission is to help our clients make **sustainable business improvements**.

Founded in 2000, OTCR has completed over **150 successful projects** with a wide variety of clients including:

- Fortune 500 corporations
- Non-profit organizations and UIUC units
- Technology entrepreneurs and start-ups

OTCR provides consulting services including **business strategy, technology strategy, and product development**.

Student Development



Second, we aim to prepare our students to be **successful leaders** now and throughout their careers.

We believe that supplementing **rigorous academics** with **real-world work** experience accelerates **students' learning and professional development**. We provide:

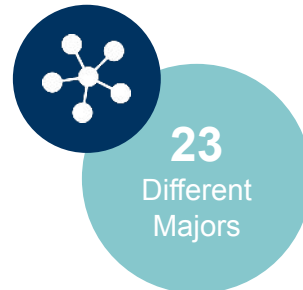
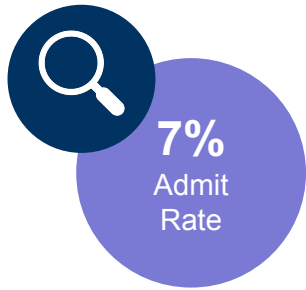
- Extensive training
- Hands on work experience
- Corporate sponsored workshops
- Accelerated leadership opportunities
- Networking with a strong alumni base



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Students must undergo three rounds of interviews before joining OTCR. Members are some of the most talented students across the University, spanning a diverse range of majors and experiences.

Student Facts



OTCR members have...

- Won first place at **national debate** tournaments
- Written apps with more than **200,000 downloads**
- Been recruited to play soccer for **international feeder** teams
- **Directed hackathons** with thousands of attendees
- Placed in the **top five** at national swim and dive competitions
- **Summited** Mount Kilimanjaro
- Started **nonprofits** for disaster relief and computer education

Members Upon Graduating

McKinsey
& Company

BCG

BAIN
& COMPANY

Google

facebook



Goldman
Sachs

J.P.Morgan



amazon



Uber ATG

FULBRIGHT



Stanford
MEDICINE



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OTCR has completed over 150 successful engagements spanning a variety of industries and functional areas. Below is an overview of our services.

Services

Business Strategy

- Operations analysis and improvements
- Market entry
- Growth strategy
- Competitive analysis

Product

- Product development and validation
- Launch strategy
- Customer insights
- Technology commercialization

Marketing

- Market trends analysis
- Campaign strategy

And More

Selected Past Clients



Testimonials

“The consultants on the OTCR team are **top notch** - they're phenomenal at taking **high level goals** and running with them.”

- Janice Yoshimura, CEO Opus Search, ex McKinsey

“The presentation and model the team created was no different than what I would see from **McKinsey or Bain.**”

- Hunter Walk, CEO PromptMed, Formerly at Goldman Sachs

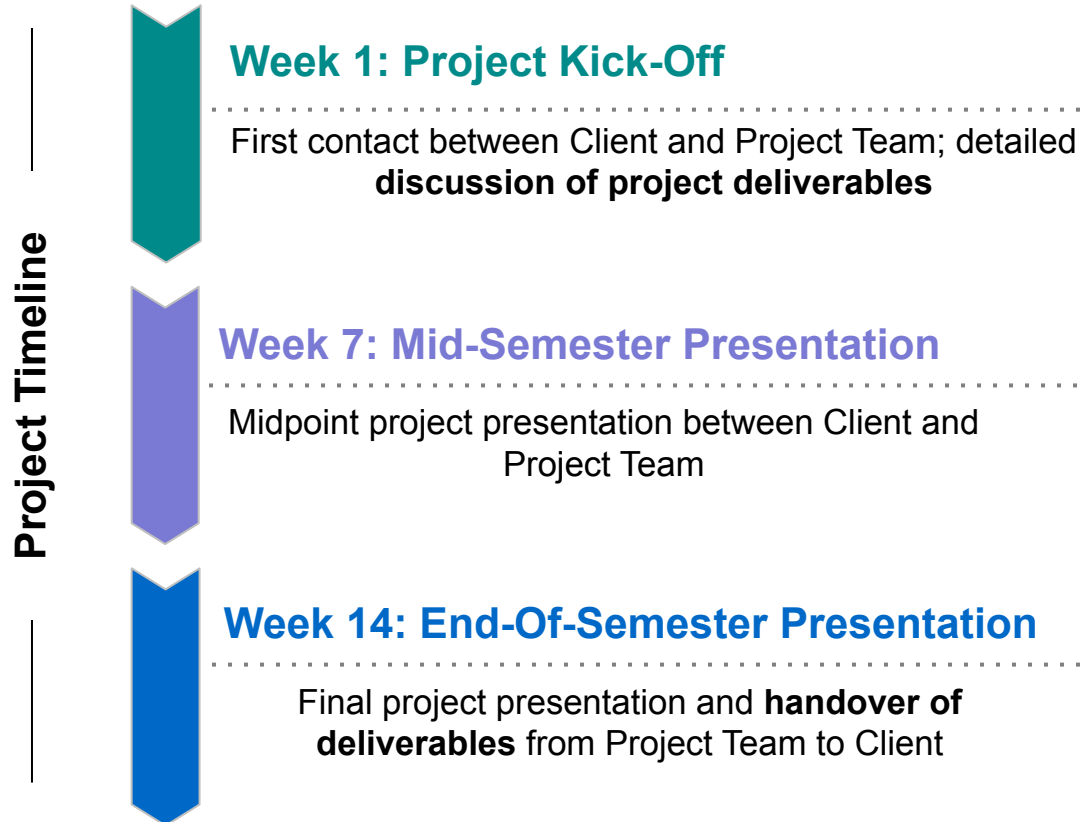
“OTCR provides **high quality work** that is impactful, accurate and timely.”

- John Fox, VP at Indeed, ex McKinsey

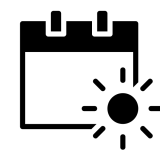
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OTCR's projects last 12-14 weeks and run according to the University calendar.

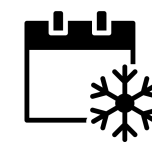


Project Dates



Spring Semester

- Start: Mid-January
- End: Late April



Fall Semester

- Start: Early September
- End: Mid-December

Remuneration

- No charges or fees
- Target donation is agreed upon before project begins
- Not obligatory, only **based on project team performance**

Weekly Client-Team interactions strike an optimal balance between your time commitment and the assurance of smooth progress for the consulting team.

OTCR's projects run on a weekly cycle: Client Update, Team Meeting and Review are the key touchpoints every week.

Project Team

- 1 Engagement Partner (Oversight)
- 1 Project Manager
- 4-6 Consultants
 - Interests and capabilities aligned with project scope
- Approximately **350–500 man hours** per semester

Commitment

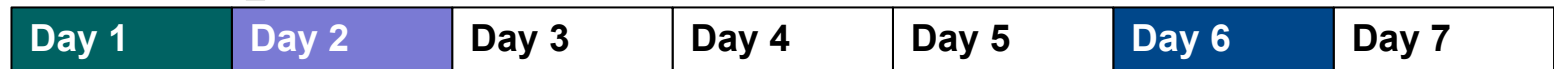
- Client to commit **1-3 hours / week**
 - **Update** with Team (usually 30-60 minutes)
 - Auxiliary **Inquiries** throughout week (~1 email)

Team Meeting

Objectives and **goals** are assigned to new workstreams to consultants.

Review

Project Manager **reviews** consultants' **workstreams** and prepares for client update.



Client Update

Meeting between Client and the Team to **discuss project progress** and **seek feedback**.

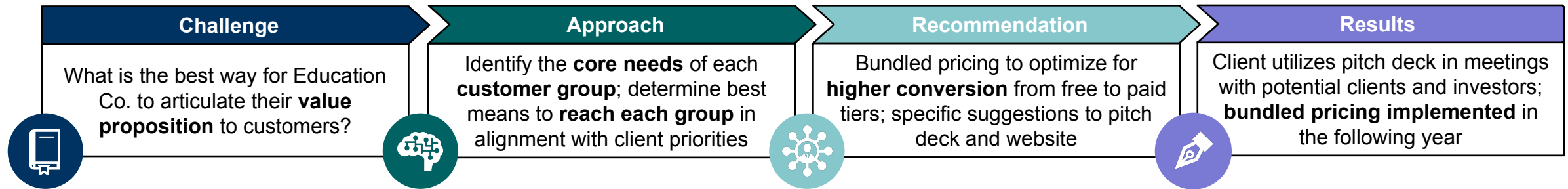
Work

Consultants **complete workstreams** as assigned by the Project Manager.

Weekly Client-Team interactions strike an optimal balance between your time commitment and the assurance of smooth progress for the consulting team.

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Education Co. was looking for the best way to articulate their value proposition in their pricing, optimal marketing strategies to reach their target market, and recommended geographic areas for expansion.



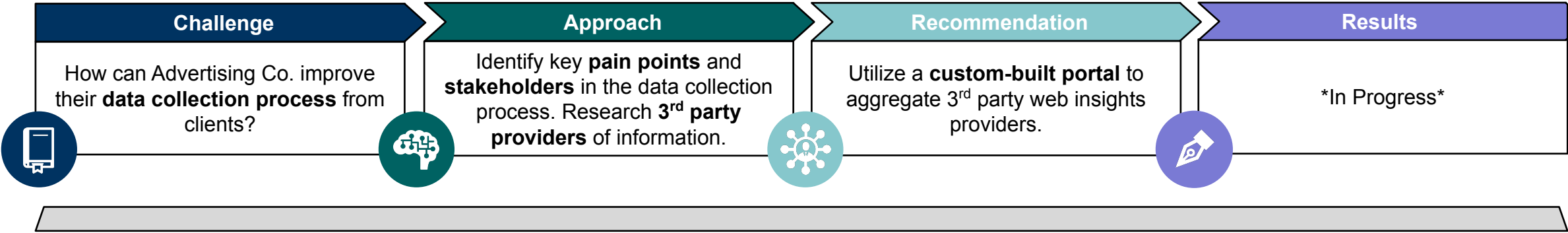
Client: Education Co. is an up-and-coming **interactive platform** to help kids and young adults find and access programs to learn relevant skills to their interests and needs. The firm is looking to solve the logistical problem of **finding the best programs for maximum reward**.

Challenge: The Client engaged OTCR in order to understand how to best articulate their **value proposition** to multiple customer groups, to determine the **optimal marketing strategy** to reach their market, and to **recommend geographic areas for expansion** in the next few years.

Solution: OTCR determined that **customer conversion from free to paid services was low because of an a-la-carte structure** and that the company's **value proposition was not clearly communicated to investors**. The project team **restructured Education Co.'s pricing structure** and **upgraded their pitch deck**. OTCR considered both passive and active marketing channels and outlined the important considerations for a successful marketing strategy. Finally, the team identified metrics that **proxy profitability and long-term viability** to recommend geographic areas.

OTCR's expertise enabled the project team to deliver actionable findings. The Client plans to implement both the marketing strategy and bundled pricing structure in the upcoming year.

Advertising Co. looked to OTCR to streamline their campaign planning process.

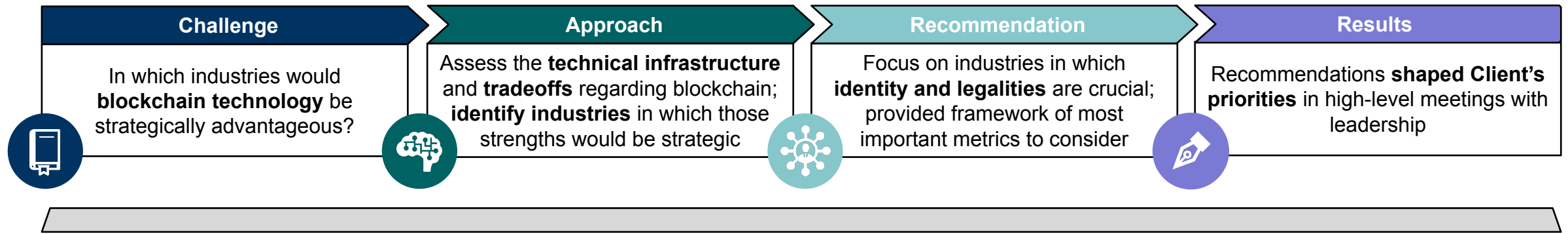


Client: Advertising Co. is an established **advertisement optimization company** that utilizes proprietary **machine learning algorithms** to improve web and email advertisements for many Fortune 500 companies.

Challenge: The Client engaged OTCR in order to understand how to improve their **campaign planning process**. Major **bottlenecks** had been identified in the data collection process, and solutions to those problems were requested.

Solution: OTCR determined that **3rd party web insights providers** would enable Advertisement Co. to collect relevant information **without needing to request** it from the client. In order to access the information in a low friction manner, a **custom-built portal** was recommended, with API integration between the portal and web insights providers. **Change management strategies** were also recommended to increase buy-in and efficiency of the portal rollout.

Technology Co. looked to OTCR to find industries in which blockchain technology would offer high potential.



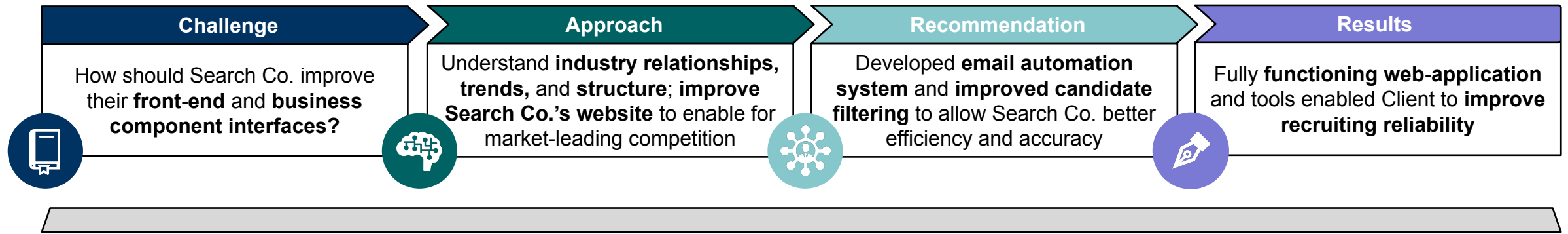
Client: Technology Co. is an **American technology company** credited with advancing technology in numerous spaces/industries and has recently seen tremendous growth with its cloud services. The company continues to remain at the forefront of technology by offering innovative enterprise solutions.

Challenge: High-level discussions were in order to discuss **blockchain technology's enterprise applications** in the near future. The Client engaged OTCR in order to identify what problems **blockchain technology is most fit to solve** and what industries would benefit from a blockchain solution.

Solution: OTCR determined that blockchain technology had optimal performance for many reads and minimal writes or edits to the data stored, lending itself well to use cases in **establishing identity and legal applications**. Such applications would incur a variety of costs if offered as an enterprise solution; the team summarized the most relevant characteristics in a **practical framework to advise in the short and long-term**. The project team similarly identified 20+ short and long-term use cases in industries ranging from **Media and Entertainment to Document Verification**.

OTCR's expertise allowed the Client to develop a deeper technical understanding and business case of blockchain technology, shaping the Client's priorities in upcoming meetings and in future years.

Search Co. looked to OTCR to implement a larger front-end interface for their candidate platform and more modular business component.



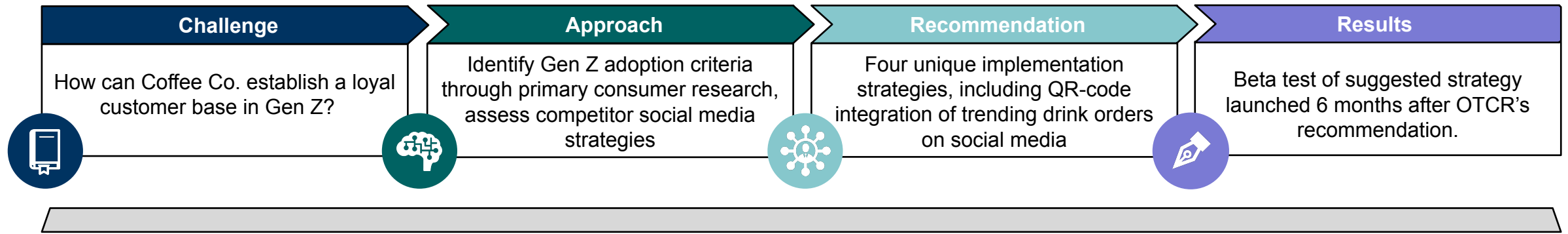
Client: Search Co. is an American **executive search firm** that performs senior-level searches nationally and internationally in a variety of public and private sector industries.

Challenge: The Client engaged OTCR to identify what an optimal senior-level search entails and to **improve their search platform front-end** and business component to allow for more successful and efficient searches.

Solution: After **considering other end-to-end recruiting platforms** and candidate preferences, OTCR identified that transparency and timeliness are success factors that Search Co. could improve in their operations. The project team identified that an **email automation system** and **improved candidate filtering** as effective solutions to this problem. Working alongside the Client, OTCR **built front-end mockups** and **fully-functioning tools** and **web-application** featuring these two components. Search Co. has used the project team's findings to refine their market position and slated the tools in a potential implementation pipeline.

OTCR's expertise allowed the Client to refine their market position and prioritize where they should focus their next operational improvements to compete above market standards.

Coffee Co. came to OTCR to find ways to drive adoption of its rewards program among Generation Z.



Client: Coffee Co. is a global coffee shop chain known for its high degree of **brand loyalty**, some of which is derived from its rewards program. Aimed at creating **efficient marketing** and **driving incremental spending**, the rewards program is closely intertwined with the company's mobile application.

Challenge: The Client engaged OTCR in order to understand factors impacting customer loyalty among Gen Z, and to develop unique strategies to **attract and retain** customers to their loyalty program moving forward.

Solution: OTCR determined that **individual expression**, **personal values**, and **social media influence** drive customer adoption among Gen Z. The project team developed several unique recommendations for the Client's mobile application, including shareable orders, a gamification feature, app personalization, and environmentally friendly order options. For each recommended feature, OTCR created an **implementation timeline** analyzing costs, resources, customer impact, and financial projections.

OTCR's expertise enabled the project team to deliver actionable findings: the Client has since been able launch a test feature of OTCR's recommendation.



Please contact Salman Shaheen at salmans3@illinois.edu for project inquiries.